

KEN CLEMONS

Sales Portfolio | Enterprise Account Executive, Gulf South | Salt Security

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PERFORMANCE RECORD

Red Hat, \$7M. 160%. Over plan three years running: 160%, then 128% of \$5M, then 137% of \$3.5M. President's Club.

Alfresco, \$4M team target. 146%. Full regional P&L, three enterprise AEs, my own \$1.5M inside the team number. President's Club.

Couchbase, territory number. 135%. Every dollar from a new customer, in a category most buyers still needed explained.

Gigamon, \$750K region. 125%. Directed the SDR, sales engineer and professional services against one regional number.

Cloudflare, \$1M. 115%. More than \$4M of pipeline across 35 named prospects, nearly all self-sourced.

Adobe, \$2M annual. Cleared every year. Over \$5M in enterprise revenue across the period. Two-time President's Club.

GULF SOUTH TERRITORY, CARRIED TODAY

Texas, Louisiana and Arkansas are inside the thirteen-state region I own at Analyst1 right now. Three of the logos I have closed there sit directly in this patch: SLB in Houston, American Airlines in Dallas Fort Worth, and Arvest Bank in Arkansas.

Bentonville and Northwest Arkansas. I live in Rogers, which puts the Bentonville hub and Northwest Arkansas National Airport both about ten minutes out. Both my degrees are from the Walton College, I still sit on alumni committees there, and I was part of getting the NWA Tech Summit off the ground. Every employer in my career has put Walmart on my account list. Regional retail relationships run through Dillard's, Bass Pro and O'Reilly Auto Parts as well.

Little Rock and Arkansas enterprise. Analyst1 put Arvest Bank on my closed list this year. Financial services across the state is a network already open to me.

Houston, Louisiana and Gulf energy. SLB and American Airlines both came out of my current book, headquartered in Houston and Dallas Fort Worth. Exxon was an Alfresco win. Energy and critical infrastructure remains a vertical I work continuously, counting Xcel Energy, Ameren, FirstEnergy and OG&E among accounts carried or landed.

Regional channel. WWT signed across four employers starting at Red Hat, then again at Cloudflare, Gigamon and Analyst1. Co-sell, deal registration and joint pipeline reviews with Optiv, GuidePoint Security, SHI and CDW.

MAPPING TO THE ROLE

API and application security depth. Two years at Cloudflare on bot management, DDoS mitigation, edge WAF and API protection. What surfaced in nearly every discovery was API estate the team could not fully account for, which is where Salt starts.

Multi-threaded cycles with CIO, CISO, AppSec, platform and cloud. The Centene agreement ran across infrastructure, application development, security and enterprise architecture before I named a number, then to the CFO organization for the financial case.

Six and seven-figure TCV with security validation. Centene closed at \$5M annual with professional services attached, through architecture review, vendor risk assessment, procurement and legal, against an embedded incumbent.

Multi-solution wins and displacement. At Cloudflare I regularly landed several products in one agreement, displacing appliance vendors and pulling point tools onto a single platform. At Red Hat I displaced a competitor already sitting across the estate. Selling discovery, posture and runtime together is the same construction.

AI agent and MCP security. I carry a quota on an AI-native security platform today, hold twenty AI certifications with the AWS Certified AI Practitioner exam scheduled, and built and shipped an iOS application from no coding background. I can lead a conversation about what an agent action layer exposes, without handing it to an SE.

Cloud-native fluency. Kubernetes and OpenShift at Red Hat, cloud database architecture at Couchbase, multi-cloud networking at Cloudflare. AWS certified, with the AWS Certified AI Practitioner exam scheduled.

Partner co-sell. WWT signed personally at four employers. Deal registration, joint account mapping and co-sell execution with Optiv, GuidePoint Security, SHI and CDW, plus AWS and cloud marketplace motions.

Forecast discipline in Salesforce. Weekly opportunity-level inspection against a written MEDDPICC bar, with risks and executive asks surfaced early. The number I submit does not get quietly revised on the last day of a quarter.

On-site workshops and travel. Living at XNA keeps Bentonville local and Houston, Dallas and the Gulf coast within easy flying distance. Regional CISO events and customer on-sites are a standing part of my prospecting rhythm, and I have carried territories as large as thirteen states.

ANCHOR DEAL: CENTENE, \$5M ANNUAL AGREEMENT, RED HAT

- Opened cold into a Fortune 25 healthcare payer with no active project and no budget line for the category.
- Multi-threaded across infrastructure, application development, security and enterprise architecture, listening for what each group was measured on before proposing anything.
- Cleared architecture review, vendor risk assessment, procurement and legal myself over several months, redlines included.
- Won against an incumbent embedded in the estate, on total cost and on a modernization roadmap the CIO could defend internally.
- Signed with professional services attached, so deployment stayed my responsibility. Anchored the year that finished at 160% of \$7M.

SELLING A CATEGORY BEFORE THE BUYER HAS A BUDGET LINE

Salt has been defining API security since 2018, so part of every cycle is still teaching. Four of the products I have carried had that same problem.

- Red Hat, open source in the enterprise. Procurement had no template for it and security had objections nobody had answered. I ran the technical evaluations and translated the outcome into economics a CFO would approve.
- Couchbase, NoSQL before it had a settled slot in the stack. Finished at 135%, every dollar from a new customer, and grew the territory pipeline 45% to roughly \$4M.
- Cloudflare, Zero Trust while the term still meant different things to different vendors. Closed 115% of \$1M with more than \$4M sourced outbound.
- Analyst1, AI-driven threat intelligence today. Buyers want proof the platform reasons over their environment specifically, and they push hard on data handling before signing.

HOW I OPEN A TERRITORY

Days 1 to 30. Learn the platform well enough to run discovery and a technical validation without support. Interview the reps and engineers on recent wins and losses. Tier the Houston, Louisiana and Arkansas account list using intent data, existing customer adjacency and my own relationship map. Reintroduce myself to WWT, Optiv and GuidePoint with Salt in hand, and open the AWS and CrowdStrike partner conversations.

Days 31 to 60. Run outbound against tier one with a message built on undiscovered API surface. Book first meetings at the Texas and Arkansas accounts where I already hold executive relationships, SLB, American Airlines and Arvest among them. Get two technical validations scoped and started. Establish forecast hygiene from week one.

Days 61 to 90. Convert the first validation to a signed agreement. Hold a partner planning session with at least one national reseller and one cloud partner. Deliver a written territory plan covering named accounts, expected sourced pipeline and the competitive patterns showing up in the region.

WHAT I BRING TO AN EXECUTIVE ROOM

- Business case construction is the part I do myself. My career started in corporate procurement, so I build the case the way the people evaluating it will read it, and I know what happens to a deal after the champion says yes.
- Sixteen years selling exclusively into large enterprises. Multi-stakeholder committees, security review, legal redlines and finance scrutiny are the normal shape of my cycle.
- Buyers across both sides of the room: CISO, AppSec and product security, platform and cloud engineering, CIO, CTO and VP Infrastructure, alongside CFO, VP Finance, procurement and legal.